

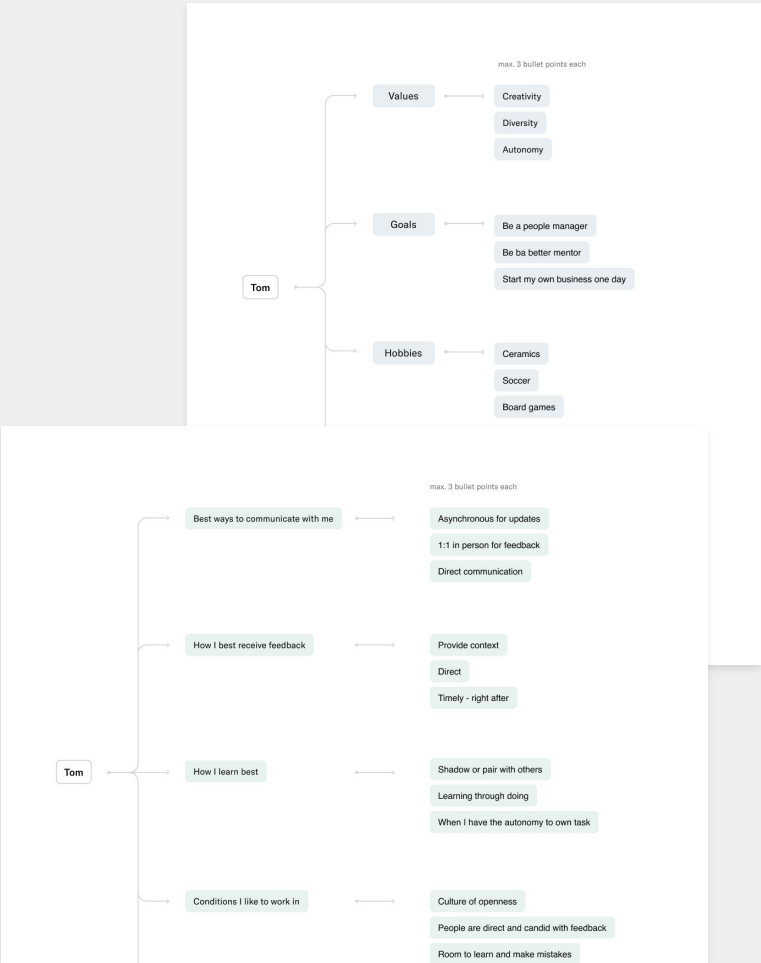
Management toolkit

My work as a coach.

MANAGEMENT TOOLKIT

Building trust with user manuals

When I join a team as a new design lead, I share a personal user manual that is a primer to who I am, how I operate, and what I value. It's a small act of vulnerability that helps build trust early and reduce potential misunderstandings. At N26, this practice evolved into a team-wide tool for onboarding and team building.



Effective 1:1 structure with direct reports

1:1s are a vital space for building strong relationships with direct reports and understanding their priorities and team dynamics.

I use a flexible meeting template that includes sections for accomplishments, priorities, blockers, questions, and action items—allowing both of us to add talking points in advance. The template evolves over time to reflect the team’s changing priorities and level of maturity.

1:1 meeting template

1:1 Meeting Template

🏆 **Accomplishments** — What's something you're proud of lately? Celebrate a win—big or small.

- ☐ Talking point
- ☐ ...

🔄 **Priorities** — List what you're currently working on and note any key progress updates or milestones.

- ☐ Talking point
- ☐ ...

🚫 **Blockers** — Are there anything getting in the way? How can I help?

- ☐ Talking point
- ☐ ...

💡 **Questions** — Do you have any questions or topics you'd like to cover before we finish?

- ☐ Talking point
- ☐ ...

✅ **Action items** — What are the key takeaways, and what are your next steps?

- ☐ Talking point
- ☐ ...

📌 **Ad-hoc keyword prompts** — Product aim, Team health, Cross-functional relationships, Growth, Craft

MANAGEMENT TOOLKIT

Enabling career development conversations with a toolkit

Aside from 1:1s every two weeks to support my direct reports, I like to have a 45-min career conversation each month with them.

Overtime, I have build a **toolkit** to facilitate career conversations for the first three months, as well as ongoing development. I have found **worksheets** to be a fun and tangible way to spark reflection and unlock dialogue. The toolkit includes:

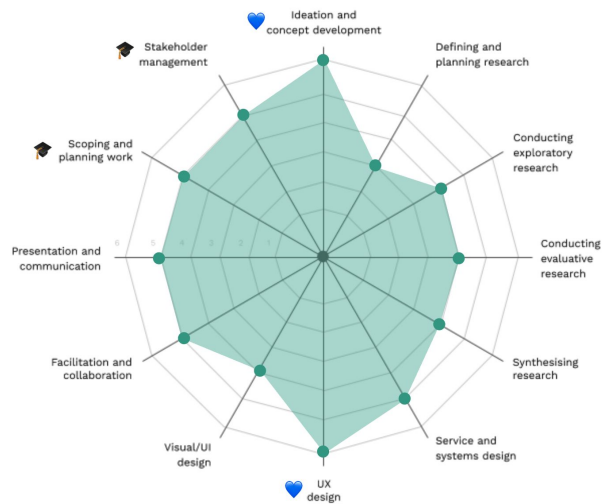
- User manual
- Skill and value maps
- Journey map
- Self assessment
- Goal setting

Self Assessment

Review the competency matrix and follow the steps 1 to 3 to reflect, self-assess, and identify areas for development.

	1. Reflect Self-assess your growth stage	2. Select Select up to 3 to focus on developing in next 6 months.	3. Plan Plan action to develop the 3 competencies of focus
Technical know-hows			
UX STRATEGY			
Clear conviction on what will impact our user and our metrics in order to influence how your team define success	Confident	☐	
Actively contribute to your x-functional team's strategy and planning	Confident	☐	
Frame what UX metrics to measure, and continuously track to identify UX improvements	Learning	☐	
DESIGN FOUNDATION			
Create and contribute components to design system to support new patterns and use cases	Learning	☐	
Proactively suggest and drive UX improvements for your product area, and process improvements on delivery within your x-functional team	Training	☐	
Manage trade-offs effectively with user and business impact in mind, and actively advocate for a customer-centric scope	Confident	☒	Take a class to strengthen my understanding of business design, and metrics
Understand when and how to conduct and design for experiments (i.e. A/B, multi-variant testing), and assess impact on metrics	Learning	☐	
UX PROCESS			
Lead discovery process in x-functional team, and practice the methods to diverge and converge effectively	Learning	☒	Own research activities in upcoming quarter in my cross-functional team
Involve x-functional collaborators and stakeholders in the process effectively	Learning	☐	
Plan and facilitate x-functional workshops effectively	Learning	☐	
RESEARCH			
Have the know-hows to apply a range of research methodologies (i.e. generative research, multi-variant testing), with guidance from user	Confident	☐	
Run user interviews autonomously	Confident	☐	
Core skills			
TIME MANAGEMENT			
Prioritise work efficiently based on objectives and key results	Training	☐	
Understand how to break down open-ended opportunities, size tasks and plan accordingly	Learning	☐	
COMMUNICATIONS			
Facilitate effective meetings, design reviews, and alignment with collaborators	Learning	☒	Find a meeting buddy to improve my facilitation skills in meetings and workshops
Actively listen and anticipate feedback in order to address it effectively	Confident	☐	
Communicate effectively to influence collaborators and stakeholders in their thinking and decisions	Learning	☐	
COLLABORATION			
Foster shared understanding of user insights in x-functional team	Confident	☐	
Educate and involve x-functional partners in customer-centric process to enable effective collaboration	Confident	☐	
Share new learnings and best practices to foster a collaborative learning environment in UX team	Learning	☐	
LEADERSHIP			
Learn to coach other UXers to elevate UX quality and encourage consistency across segment	Learning	☐	
Actively seek out and apply lessons and inspiration from the success of others, and encourage others to share	Learning	☐	

Vivian's skill map



Vision for next 6 months

Envision yourself in 6 month's time. Where would you want to be in your professional role?
What are actions you can take toward achieving your goals in your vision?

2021:

Be fluent in metrics that matter to our product and business

Be able to work closely with data analysts
Be able to champion UX metrics in a functional teams
General design decisions on data, and evidence from research

Actions:

- Apply techniques from "Design Thinking and Predictive Analytics for Data Products" course
- Pair with data analyst and researcher on upcoming discovery

Vivian's journey in 2020

Create a timeline of your last year with highlights and low lights



My work as
an operator.

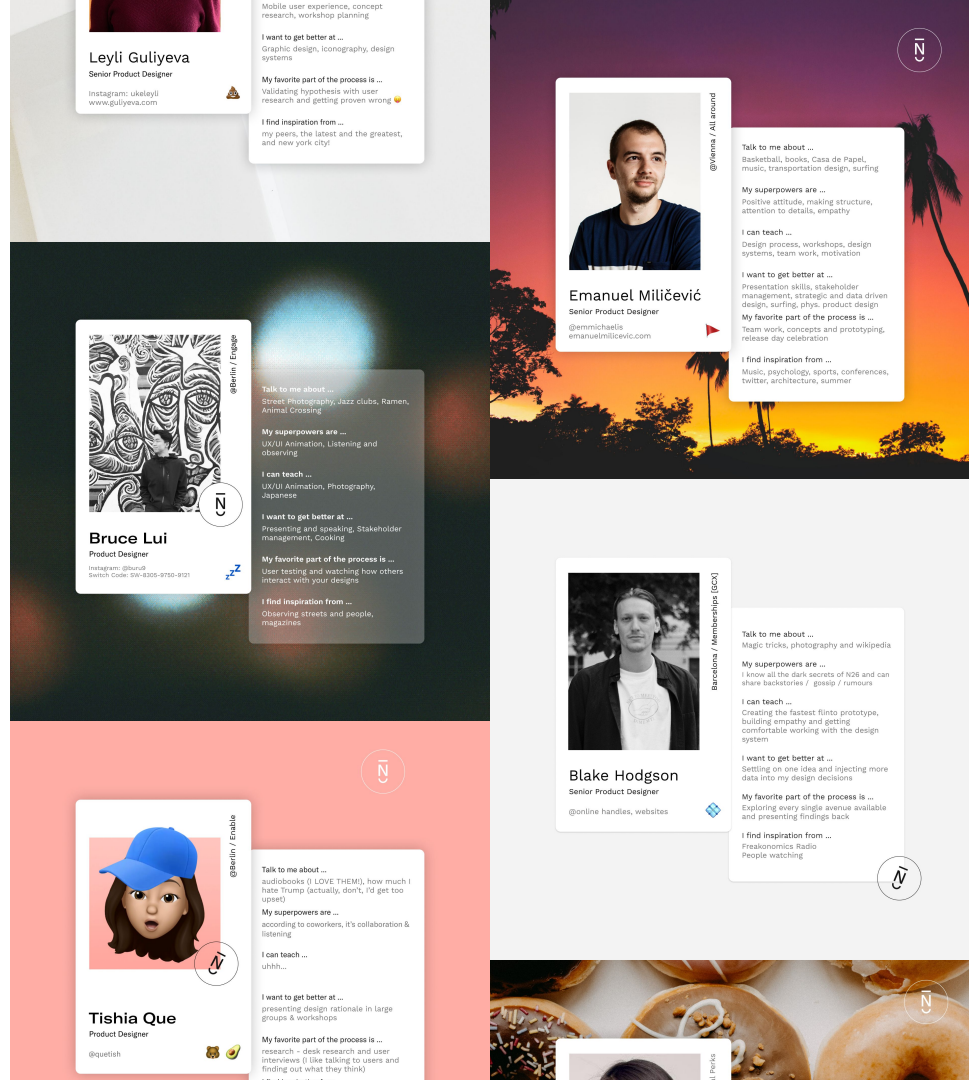
MANAGEMENT TOOLKIT

Fostering a sense of belonging with play time

I am a firm believer in bringing levity to work, especially with remote work. Aside from our weekly stand-ups, the **monthly team time** is a safe space for the team to creatively check-in with each other, do fun activities together, get weird, and openly share thoughts and concerns.

I led the first two and created a loose structure with the team. From then on, each team member takes turn to host. Some of the activities we did:

- Virtual arts and craft
- Create your profile card
- Storytelling time
- Remote exquisite corpse
- Documentary viewing party
- Virtual improv



Leyli Guliyeva
Senior Product Designer

Instagram: ukeleyli
www.guliyeva.com

I want to get better at ...
Mobile user experience, concept research, workshop planning

My favorite part of the process is ...
Graphic design, iconography, design systems

I find inspiration from ...
my peers, the latest and the greatest, and new york city!



Bruce Lui
Product Designer

Instagram: @lbrun8
Switch Code: SW-8305-9750-8121

Talk to me about ...
Street Photography, Jazz clubs, Ramen, Anime Crossing

My superpowers are ...
UX/UI Animation, Listening and observing

I can teach ...
UX/UI Animation, Photography, Japanese

I want to get better at ...
Presenting and speaking, Stakeholder management, Cooking

My favorite part of the process is ...
User testing and watching how others interact with your designs

I find inspiration from ...
Observing streets and people, magazines



Tishia Que
Product Designer

@quetish

Talk to me about ...
audiobooks (I LOVE THEM!), how much I hate Trump (actually, don't, I'd get too upset)

My superpowers are ...
according to coworkers, it's collaboration & listening

I can teach ...
uhhh...

I want to get better at ...
presenting design rationale in large groups & workshops

My favorite part of the process is ...
research - desk research and user interviews (I like talking to users and finding out what they think)



Emanuel Miličević
Senior Product Designer

@emmichaelis
emanuilmilicevic.com

Talk to me about ...
basketball, books, Casa de Papel, music, transportation design, surfing

My superpowers are ...
Positive attitude, making structure, attention to details, empathy

I can teach ...
Design process, workshops, design systems, team work, motivation

I want to get better at ...
Presentation skills, stakeholder management, strategic and data driven design, surfing, phys. product design

My favorite part of the process is ...
Team work, concepts and prototyping, release day celebration

I find inspiration from ...
Music, psychology, sports, conferences, twitter, architecture, summer



Blake Hodgson
Senior Product Designer

@online handles, websites

Talk to me about ...
Magic tricks, photography and wikipedia

My superpowers are ...
I know all the dark secrets of NZB and can share backstories / gossip / rumours

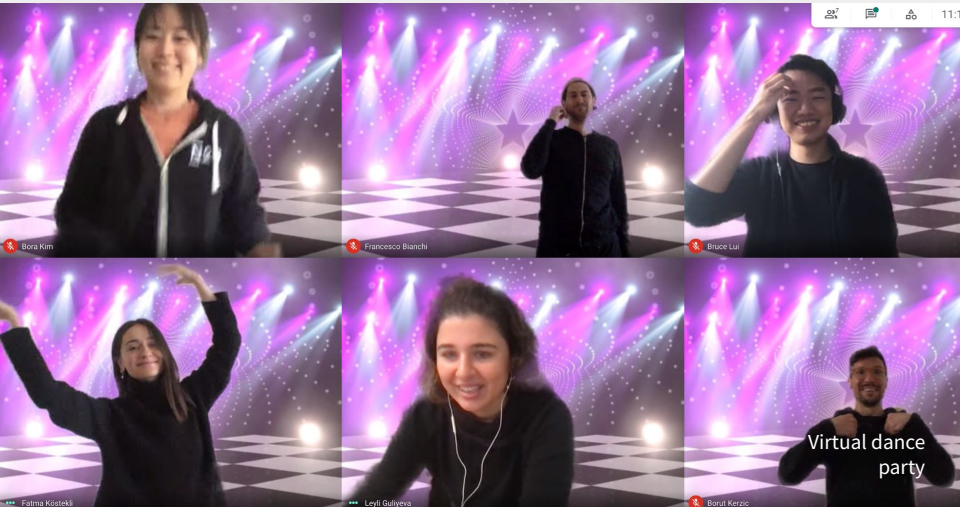
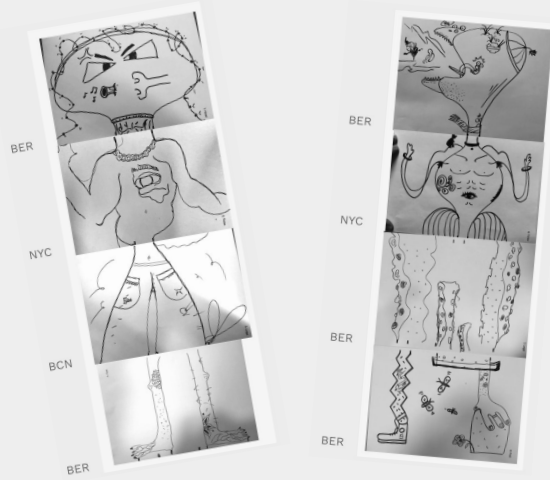
I can teach ...
Creating the fastest flinto prototype, building empathy and getting comfortable working with the design system

I want to get better at ...
Settling on one idea and injecting more data into my design decisions

My favorite part of the process is ...
Exploring every single avenue available and presenting findings back

I find inspiration from ...
Freakonomics Radio
People watching

Virtual exquisite corpse



Virtual dance party

Weather report check-in



Cloudy — Sunny. Things are getting clearer, sunny days are waiting for us ☺



Fatma



Snowy, with no chance of sun. Maybe in a month.



Leyli



It's been a strong hurricane happening recently and as a result we are having some strong winds that push us around.



Mireia



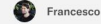
Just kinda grey. Some fog. But mostly cold so gotta put on some extra layers.



Bruce



Cloudy. The only sun you're able to see is in past pictures. Need new Vitamin-D pills. Projects are alright though :)



Francesco



The last month we have seen overcast with a lot of snow. Overcast in the sense of in clarity with hiring support, and the pressure there. but the snow makes it feel cozy.



Vivian



Rapidly mixed weather conditions. From using shades for sunny good mood ready, to an umbrella to protect from storms, to a cosy sweater for the gloomy days.



Borut



It's been cold and rainy month, but sun is coming up! Struggled with health conditions, but recovered now!

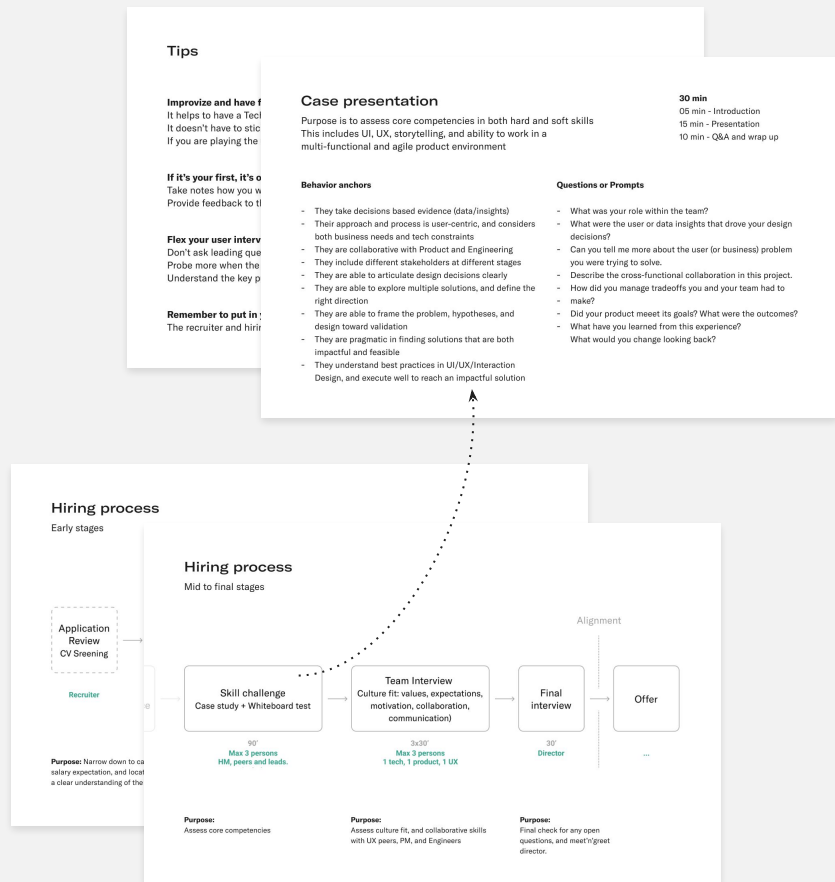


Bora

MANAGEMENT TOOLKIT

Optimize hiring through team enablement

As the team scaled quickly, our leadership struggled to keep pace with hiring demands. I partnered with another design lead and our recruiting partner to streamline the process—creating **interview training and guides** that empowered the broader team to actively support hiring.



Supporting a clear growth path

At the end of 2020, an internal survey at N26 revealed a drop in team engagement, largely due to unclear roles and responsibilities. This impacted not just career growth, but also hiring, performance reviews, and cross-functional collaboration.

Together with a design lead and a people lead, I co-created a **competency matrix and growth playbook** through an inclusive process involving execs and leads. The matrix clarified expectations at each level, while the playbook articulated growth paths aligned with company guidelines and tailored to our team's values and craft.

Product Designer Level: Survey

The purpose of this survey is to better understand the current role and responsibilities of designers on each level. This is a first step to create a deeper definition for product design roles, so we can provide better guidance to designers along their career journey, as well as, better alignment in hiring and career development.

When answering these questions, please try to be as candid as possible.

This should take no longer than 10 minutes. Thanks in advance for your input! 🙏

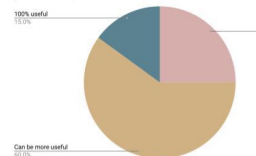


These are the mindsets defined for your level in State of Design. How useful are they to your career development? *

- I have a positive attitude: instead of complaining
- I raise improvement ideas in a constructive manner

Leveling survey results

Usefulness of growth dimension: Impact & Influence



Question: Count of These are the impact and influence defined for you. How useful are they to your career development?

Leveling survey results

Most crucial skills across PD, SPD, LPD

Skills	%	
	crucial	good to have
Service Design	15.0%	70.0%
Copy writing	25.0%	60.0%
Designing system (ie. applying, contributing, shaping our design system)	30.0%	70.0%
Data-driven design (ie. understanding and applying metrics to your design decision)	30.0%	70.0%
User research and synthesis	40.0%	55.0%
Business thinking (ie. understand business context and business levers)	40.0%	60.0%
Understanding agile (ie. understand agile development and process)	50.0%	40.0%
Information architecture	55.0%	40.0%
Prototyping	55.0%	40.0%
Workshop facilitation	55.0%	40.0%
UI and visual design	55.0%	45.0%
Technical understanding (ie. understand iOS guidelines and constraints)	65.0%	25.0%
Scoping and planning work	65.0%	35.0%
Presentation and meeting facilitation	70.0%	30.0%
Stakeholder management	75.0%	20.0%
Product thinking (ie. understand value proposition design, and product market fit)	75.0%	25.0%
Shipping design (ie. understand how to handoff designs and support development)	80.0%	15.0%
Ideation and Concepting	85.0%	15.0%

— UX

Roles & Responsibilities Playbook

20
21

Discipline definition

Product Design

Product Design is responsible for translating customer and business needs into useful and delightful user experiences. They drive design activity in all phases of a product, from discovery to delivery to iteration.

L5 Product Design Lead
L4 Senior Product Designer
L3 Product Designer
Associate Product Designer

UX Roles and Responsibilities Playbook

Dimensions of growth

There are three dimensions of growth that represent value most in each UX discipline. The same three exist at all levels, and are designed to embody our company's guidance.

Sphere of
Impact

Scope of contribution
and influence

UX Roles and Responsibilities Playbook

Competencies

There are competencies within each dimension. For example, there are four competencies in "Technical know-hows", and five competencies in "Core skills" for Product Design.

Technical
know-hows

Technical knowledge
and skills required to
do the job

UX strategy

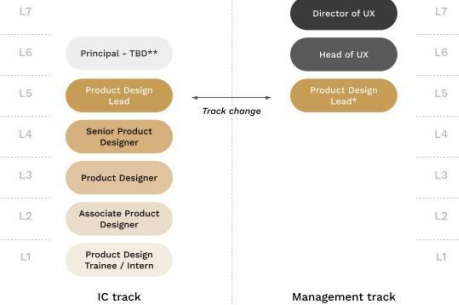
Design execution

UX process

Research

UX Roles and Responsibilities Playbook

Product Design



Product Design: L1 to L5

Core competencies

PRODUCT DESIGN	L1: Trainee / Intern	L2: Associate (In addition to Trainee / Intern)	L3: Mid-level (In addition to Associate)	L4: Senior (In addition to Mid-level)	L5: Lead (In addition to Senior)
Sphere of Impact					
Scope	Single x-functional team with increasing independence and influence				Primarily single X-functional team, and a force multiplier for the UX practice
Technical know-hows					
UX strategy	- Actively seek, and understand the brief and problem at hand - Understand N26's target customer personas - Be data curious	- Be aware of your x-functional team's strategy - Understand the user cases and/or jobs to be done for your product area - Understand competitive landscape, and how to benchmark UX	- Understand the current state of UX, success metrics and outcomes in your x-functional team, how your product performs, and frame your work accordingly - Be hypothesis driven, and understand how to define problems that relate back to your team's goals	- Clear conviction on what will impact our user and our metrics in order to influence how your team define success - Actively contribute to your x-functional team's strategy and planning - Frame what UX metrics to measure,	- Create cross-segment alignment with other UX leads to make sure we are aligned and working towards a shared UX vision - Proactively partake in product prioritization, and assure user-centricity in the process and roadmap
Design execution	- Understand visual and interaction design fundamentals, i.e. color, typography, hierarchy, patterns, states - Understand laws in UX (ie. Fitt's Law) - Learn about technical guidelines for iOS, android, and/or learn about web standards and best practices on accessibility	- Can follow our brand guidelines and design system, and apply components - Pay attention to detail on execution, and be thorough in delivery - Understand how to handle edge cases and failure states - Understand the ways of working for optimal delivery by working closely with engineering partners	- Good understanding of our design system, and mobile and web patterns in order to apply them effectively - Design holistic flows, with consideration of our personas' user journeys - Know when to leverage on prototyping to define animation and transition our tech partners - Drive design delivery, and active facilitate design review to create alignment with x-functional part team - Ensure quality assurance of what built by working closely with engineering partners - Know when to explore through conceptualizing - Understand how to facilitate sprint ideation session, and design sprint - Actively share your work for feedback and converge through design review with team		
UX process	- Learn about the product design activities and UX process at N26, from discovery to delivery to iterations	- Learn to apply process and frameworks to frame problems, to resolve dependencies and unblock, with support from other designers	- Understand how to facilitate sprint ideation session, and design sprint		
Research	- Learn about user research fundamentals, and understand the role of user research in product development	- Understand how to apply user insights status clearly and coherently - Participate in user research sessions, and learn about interview techniques	- Facilitate usability testing to validate your design decisions - Create discussion guides, and synthesize learnings with guideline researchers - Iterate on designs based on user insights		
Core skills					
Time management	- Learn to seek help to unblock yourself	- Actively clarify scope, plan your work, and get feedback from x-functional partners, and other UXers	- Be able to work autonomously - Learn to prioritize your work, and manage time effectively to ship a impactful	- open-ended opportunities, size tasks and plan accordingly	- Coach other UXers on effective time management for their work
Communications	- Openly communicate your work, and seek feedback from other UXers and x-functional partners	- Regularly communicate your work and status clearly and coherently - Articulate your reasoning well	- Adapt your communication to effectively engage with different audiences in different settings - Develop opinions and openly share	- Facilitate effective meetings, design reviews, and alignment with collaborators - Actively listen and anticipate feedback	- Ensure effective communication practices within segment to increase visibility of UX work and their impact - Ensure UX work is well-communicated

Key differences in levels

By dimensions of growth

		L1: Trainee	L2: Associate (In addition to Trainee)	L3: Mid-level (In addition to Associate)	L4: Senior (In addition to Mid-Level)	L5: Lead (In addition to Senior)	L6: Head (In addition to Lead)	L7: Director (In addition to Head)
Sphere of Impact	Scope (PO)	Single x-functional team with increasing independence and influence						
	Scope (UP)	Single x-functional team with increasing independence and influence		Work independently within 1 or 2 x-functional teams				
	Ownership	Owns small projects or pieces of larger projects		Delivers end-to-end pieces of larger projects	Responsible for 2 or more x-functional teams within a segment.	Responsible for the segment and a force multiplier for the UX practice	Autonomous force multiplier for the entire segment	Autonomous force multiplier for the entire organization
Technical know-hows	Strategy & vision	Support others on execution	Primarily focused on execution	Understand segment strategy and vision	Actively contributes to roadmap and planning	Growing influence in segment to implement strategy	Actively contributes to segment strategy	Actively contributes to organisation strategy
	Expertise	Actively learning	May have growth areas in some competencies, but actively learning	Proficient across most competencies for their level	Comfortable in solving complex problems	Highly efficient, excellent at balancing effort vs reward	Comfortable in leading complex projects	Deep context of the entire product and competition
Organizational competencies	Leadership	NA	Contributes to their x-functional team	Co-leading their team with their PM and Dev		Pairs with their x-functional leads to ensure quality work effectively	Co-leads their segment together with other segment leads	Co-leads the org together with other directors
Manager track		NA				Actively gives feedback and mentors designers in their segment		
						Eligible for transfer to management track		

Building clear principles, rituals, and processes

As N26's product design team doubled in size with our company's hyper-growth, the design leadership team realized we need new team processes and rituals to maintain or grow our design excellence. I co-led a series of workshops with other Product and Design Leads across the company to determine our principles, and synthesized the outcomes to **a set of UX principles** to guide design and decision-making. The leads team and I also co-created a toolkit for designers to share helpful tools with their UX peers.

This includes a **template of rituals and tools** to facilitate **design critiques** and **product reviews** with design leads and xfn leadership.

UX Principles



Be contextual and feel personal

#no-spam #delight

Learn from user behaviors, and adapt to the user's context and preferences. Allow users to shape their unique experience and don't miss the chance to delight them.



Empower toward action

#no-overload #simple

Provide the tools and information to enable users to make meaningful choices. Navigating finances can be overwhelming and anxiety inducing. Strive to distill complexity and instill confidence.



Create cohesive connections

#no-siloes #holistic

Build unified inter-connected experiences across all platforms that enable users to explore products & features seamlessly in the right moments, and intuitively along their financial journey.



Earn trust

#reliability

Build toward that enable users to entrust money to N26. And don't miss the chance to delight them.



One size does not fit all

#accessibility

Design an experience where we can help users become a part of our community.



Evolution of experience

#handhold

Users are not just heavy internet users, they are always online.

Rituals

UR
PO & UR
Segment
Global UR
PTX

Ritual	Frequency	Participants	Purpose	Trackability	Preowner	Notes
Engagement Strategy Engagement audit	Tri-weekly	Engagement Segment	Segment updates, people and product	Slide Deck	Anyone	
Business plan show + full B2B audit	Weekly	UR Segment	Segment updates, people and product	Slide Deck	Anyone	
UX All Hands	Monthly	UX	Team updates, cultural activity, celebration	Slide Deck	UX leadership	
Creative & UX show + call	Every 6 wks	Creative + UX	Share and learn from both teams' work	Slide Deck	Creative + UX	
PTX All Hands	Monthly	Everyone in PTX	PTX wide updates	Slide Deck	PTX Leadership	
PTX Culture and Content	Quarterly	Everyone in PTX	PTX teamwide reflection, inspiration, share of learnings	Slide Deck	Anyone	
UR Stand-up	Weekly	PO + UR	Kickoff the week by sharing goals for the week, and highlights from weekend	-	Anyone	No prep
Critique session	Weekly	PO + UR	Help each other unblock, and elevate quality of our work	Agenda	Anyone	Two 30-min slots. Sign up at least 1 week in advance
			Phrases: UR each other as a team. "Prevent" not "avoid"			



Design crit

Format: Hangout

Cadence/duration: Once weekly / 1 hour / 30 min slots (2 slot each)

Purpose: help each other unblock, and elevate quality of our work

Definition of good: active, interactive, equal in participation, productive and rewarding, have psychological safety to share raw work

Tool and resources: modes of critique, figma templates

Sign up

Sign up for one of two time slots.

CW	Slot 1 (30 min)	Slot 2 (30 min)
3	Topic Name	Topic Name
4	Green Dot review (Bruce)	Split bill - MVP review (Borut)

Rituals and tools

Modes of critiques

Which mode are you in? What kind of feedback would be helpful for you and your team right now?



Moment

Need

Vibe

Helpful Prompts

	INSPIRE	PROVOKE	CLARIFY	NUDGE	NIP & TUCK
Need	We know a little about this topic and need inspiration.	When we look at the work and it's not innovative.	When we have tons of great stuff but we need to narrow down.	When we want to take the work up a level.	When we're near a milestone but we think the work could be tighter or sharper.
Vibe	"Think about..."	"What if..."	"I love..."	"Yes, and..."	"Let's..."
	Provocative Challenging Energizing Expansive	Provocative Challenging Contentious	Cathartic Solidifying Confident	Motivating Aspirational	Solidifying Fine-tuning Laser-focused
Helpful Prompts	Let's consider these examples ...	What edges are we pushing?	Which direction fits our principles?	What will make this shine?	If we had a day/week, how could we make it better?

Source: Modified from IDEO's original version. See source [here](#).

4. NXD Toolbox

Created by Christian Hertel
Last updated: Mar 04, 2021

What you can find here:

In this space you can find various different tools clustered in categories describing project, kicking off, competitor analysis,

How to use this toolbox:

You can search for keywords and terms:

type here your search

Or browse by category:

Category	To
4.1 Discovering Briefs	To
4.2 Kick offs	To
4.3 Broad research	Gr
4.4 Concepts	
4.5 Prototyping and testing	
4.6 Scope Definition	
4.7 Building	
4.8 Measure refine and learn	
4.9 Learning Material	Ex
How can we improve this toolbox?	

Discovery Canvas

Created by Henrik Hagedorn (Unlicensed)
Last updated: Jul 15, 2020 · 3 min read

Purpose	As a team, head into discovery with a shared 360° view on the project
Outcome	A HMW or Hypothesis to kickoff discovery with
Time	60 min
Who can help	@Vivian Lo @Somayeh Gelehpordeh (Unlicensed) @Henrik Hagedorn (Unlicensed)
Source	NXD DIY

Why use it

NXD Discovery Canvas gives you a head start into the discovery 360° view on every aspect of the initiative.

Works best when used with your team. Bring everyone on the

What you need

1. NXD Discovery Canvas
2. Your team
3. Timekeeping and facilitation

When and how to use it

- right at the start of a project, before going into discovery
- use the Figma file for a remote workshop with product and engineers
- Engineers don't have Figma licenses yet. Consider replicating to Jamboard
- Timebox every segment. It doesn't need to be perfect. Use what you can, then move on

Got stuck? It's natural to not have all the answers at the start. Instead, think in terms of assumptions that can be refined. It's **more important to get started than to be right**. A good shuffle sections of the framework that don't feel helpful right now.

Customer Problem or Need

What problems or opportunities can we observe?
How is this solved today?

Customers don't understand when their card will be delivered

Business Problem or Need

What business problems or opportunities do we see?
How is this solved today?

We want to improve the contribution margin of memberships

Desired Outcome and OKR Fit

How does this fit into what we are trying to achieve?
How is this supposed to add value for our customers?

OKR Fit

increasing contribution margin by reducing CS contacts related to card delivery questions by 5%

Dependencies, Risks and Constraints

What might limit us or impose a risk to the success of our initiative?
Are there any other teams, technical architecture dependencies?

Needs new data pipelines from backend to frontend

What if the card delivery estimate is not accurate enough?

HMW or Hypothesis

If you look back to all the previous steps, how could we solve the problem?
How-Might-We statement or hypothesis to kickoff discovery

We believe that greater transparency around card delivery data will lead to a decrease in CS contacts related to card delivery questions